

NATIONAL SECURITY COUNCIL

WASHINGTON, D.C. 20506

Summary of Conclusions
Meeting of NSC Principals Committee
DATE: January 20, 1994 [S]
LOCATION: White House Situation Room
TIME: 2:35 - 4:00 p.m.

PARTICIPANTS:

Chair
Anthony Lake

OVP
Leon Fuerth

State
Peter Tarnoff

DOD
Secretary William Perry

UN
Ambassador Madeleine Albright

CIA
Acting Director William
Studeman

JCS
ADM William Owens

White House
Samuel Berger
Nancy Soderberg

NSC
Alexander Vershbow
John Beyrle

Summary of ConclusionsRUSSIA/CHECHNYA

1. The Principals reviewed the situation on the ground in and around Grozny and discussed the likelihood that Russian forces will continue to face opposition from irregular forces, perhaps augmented by outside mercenaries. The CIA was requested to produce a short (2 pg) paper analyzing the implications of the Chechnya affair for surrounding ethnic regions (e.g., Ingushetia, Dagestan, Abkhazia) and actions those regions may be taking in reaction to Chechnya. **Action: CIA. (S)**

2. The Principals agreed on the need for a careful line of public comment that welcomed positive developments, like the prospect of eventual free elections in Chechnya, while not seeming to cheerlead blindly for what might prove an unacceptable solution, e.g., installation of a puppet regime. Press guidance

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prepared for the President's use was circulated to ensure that comments by Principals or their spokespersons would be consistent. (S)

3. Principals discussed the need to identify points of leverage we may be able to use to influence Yeltsin and other Russian officials to make the right choices on reform issues and in further steps in Chechnya. Such points could include the scheduling of the next summit, or the nature of Russian participation in Halifax G-7 meeting. **Action: NSC and State to develop a game plan.** (S)

4. Ambassador Albright discussed persistent problems with Russian positions at the U.N. which directly counter or challenge our interests, most notably the UNMIH mandate issue. Principals agreed that if attempts over the coming week to convince the Russians to support the U.S. position are unsuccessful, the President should seek Yeltsin's support in a letter. **Action: State to continue diplomatic efforts; NSC to draft letter, if needed.** (S)

FORMER YUGOSLAVIA

Bosnia:

1. Principals reviewed the status of the cease-fire and cessation of hostilities agreement and Contact Group efforts to renew negotiations on a political settlement. They agreed that Deputies should review territorial and constitutional issues that will arise in the negotiations but that the USG must be careful to avoid any appearance of departing from its commitment to the Contact Group plan. Recognizing the possibility of a continuing impasse in the negotiations, Principals directed that a mid-term diplomatic strategy paper be prepared for Deputies' review as preparation for a future discussion by Principals. **Action: State.** (S)

2. Principals discussed the upcoming Washington visit of Bosnian Prime Minister Silajdzic and the impact it could have on Congressional support for unilateral lifting of the arms embargo. State undertook to circulate a paper outlining a strategy for handling the Silajdzic visit. **Action: State.** (S)

Croatia:

3. Principals reviewed options available for responding to President Tudjman's decision to terminate UNPROFOR's mandate in Croatia when it expires on March 31. Recognizing the important strategic interests that the U.S. has in Croatia, the Principals

directed that talking points prepared for USDP Slocombe's meeting with President Tudjman be appropriately modified to focus on the risks of the decision on the ground, our commitment to a reinvigorated diplomatic effort aimed at reintegration of the occupied areas, and our support for retention of at least part of the UNPROFOR contingent. **Action: OSD/State (S)**

4. Principals discussed the potential difficulties of withdrawing UNPROFOR from Croatia, in the event withdrawal takes place, and asked the Deputies to promptly review the political and military aspects of supporting UNPROFOR withdrawal. **Action: State and JCS prepare papers on political and military aspects of U.S./NATO support for withdrawal of UNPROFOR/Croatia. (S)**

Congressional and Public Affairs Strategy:

5. Principals discussed next steps in dealing with Congress following the previous week's interagency briefings and asked that an unclassified version of LTG Clark's testimony on unilateral lifting of the arms embargo be prepared for follow-up briefings on the Hill. Principals agreed on the importance of defeating a vote on unilateral lift rather than allowing the Congress to put the President in the position of having to use the veto. They also agreed to defer a decision on the timing for publishing Secretary Perry's op-ed. **(S)**

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